

Options Screener: Decision Matrix & Troubleshooting Guide

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Author: Chief Systems Engineer

1. Tactical Command Reference

Use this matrix to choose the right command for your current goal.

Goal	Command	Why
Daily Hunting	<code>python run.py --top 15</code>	Scans all high-liquidity tickers for the best 15 trades.
Ticker Deep-Dive	<code>python run.py -s NVDA</code>	Focuses all scoring logic on a single stock you already like.
Portfolio Review	<code>python3 -m src.check_pnl</code>	Essential before every trade to ensure you aren't "over-leveraged."
Strategy Tuning	<code>./scripts/calibration_status.sh</code>	Check if your machine-learning weights are ready to be updated.
Visual Analysis	<code>python run.py --viz</code>	Opens the 3D Plotly visualizer to see the IV surface.

2. Market Regime Decision Matrix

The "best" strategy changes based on the **VIX (Volatility Index)** level.

VIX < 15 (Low Volatility / "Bull Market")

- Optimal Mode:** Discovery or Single-stock .
- Focus:** Long Calls on momentum stocks. Look for `rvol > 1.2` .
- Risk:** IV is low, so "IV Crush" risk is minimal, but "Theta Burn" is high if the stock stays flat.

VIX 15 - 25 (Normal / "Range-bound")

- Optimal Mode:** Credit Spreads or Iron Condors .
- Focus:** Selling premium. Look for `VRP Score > 0.60` .
- Risk:** Ensure your spreads are wide enough to survive small spikes in volatility.

VIX > 25 (High Volatility / "Market Panic")

- Optimal Mode:** Long Gamma or Premium Selling .
- Focus:** Long Puts (buying protection) or Short Puts (if you have the cash to buy the stock at a discount).
- Risk:** Spreads will be wide and fills will be difficult. Cut `max_bid_ask_spread_pct` slack to 0.20.

3. Troubleshooting: "Why are there 0 results?"

If the screener returns 0 rows, check these three things in order:

1. **Market Hours:** If it is 8:00 PM ET, the "Bid/Ask" prices are \$0.00. The system filters these out to protect you from "bad fills."
 - *Fix:* Wait for market open OR use the `--no-cache` flag to try forcing a refresh.
 2. **Ticker Liquidity:** You are scanning a stock that nobody trades options on.
 - *Fix:* Use `--watchlist liquid_large_cap` to ensure you are looking at stocks with enough volume.
 3. **Spread Filter:** Your `max_bid_ask_spread_pct` is too tight (default 0.15).
 - *Fix:* Check `config.json`. If the market is volatile, you may need to increase this to 0.20 temporarily.
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4. Decision Fatigue: How to pick "The One"

When you have 5 "Top Picks" and only \$1,000 to spend:

1. **Check Ticker Correlation:** Do you already have a trade in a similar stock? (e.g., If you own MSFT calls, don't buy AAPL calls).
 2. **Compare PoP vs. RR:**
 - If you want a "Safe" trade: Pick the one with the highest **PoP** (Probability of Profit).
 - If you want a "Moonshot": Pick the one with the highest **RR Ratio** and **RVOL**.
 3. **Trust the Technical Score:** If one pick has 5 stars (0.90) and the other has 4 (0.80), always take the 5-star pick. The math has already accounted for the risk.
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5. Maintenance Checklist

- **Daily:** Run `scripts/enforce_exits.sh` to ensure you don't miss a Profit Target or Stop Loss.
 - **Weekly:** Run `scripts/calibrate_snapshot.sh` to see if your signals are getting stronger or weaker.
 - **Monthly:** Back up your `paper_trades.db` file. This is your most valuable asset—it contains your personal "edge."
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END OF REFERENCE